# Focus Group Session Guide

**Evaluating the Three-Stage Framework for XAI Requirements Engineering**

## Session Purpose & Background

Thank you for agreeing to participate in this focus group session. This session is a continuation of our earlier research where you shared your experience with current requirements engineering (RE) practices in handling **explainability requirements** in AI systems.

We have since developed a **three-stage framework**, focusing on **elicitation**, **specification**, and **validation** of XAI requirements. Based on the challenges and gaps identified during your previous participation. The goal of this session is to **evaluate the practicality, usability, and completeness** of the proposed framework.

Your feedback is crucial to shaping a more effective RE process for explainable AI systems.

## Session Objectives

By the end of this session, we aim to:

- Evaluate how well the framework supports XAI requirement activities.
- Understand its strengths and limitations in practical contexts.
- Gather your input on improvements or adjustments.
- Assess whether the framework addresses previously identified challenges.

## Session Structure

The session will be structured as follows (approx. 180 minutes):

| Phase | Activity | Duration |
|---|---|---|
| Introduction & Overview | Presentation of the framework and objectives | 15 min |
| Stage 1: Elicitation | Identify explainability requirements using the framework | 30 min |
| Debrief & Discussion | Reflect on framework strengths, weaknesses, and suggestions | 15 - 20 min |
| Stage 2: Specification | Specify selected requirements in an actionable form | 30 min |
| Debrief & Discussion | Reflect on framework strengths, weaknesses, and suggestions | 15 - 20 min |
| Stage 3: Validation | Discuss how the specified requirements could be validated | 30 min |
| Discussion & Closure | Reflect on framework strengths, weaknesses, and suggestions | 30 - 40 min |

We will use a **running example AI system from the automotive domain** during the session to simulate a real-world application of the framework.

## Your Role

As a participant, you will:

- Review a scenario and apply each stage of the framework.
- Think aloud as you work through each activity.
- Provide feedback through discussion and interaction.
- Reflect on how well the framework would fit within your work context.

No preparation is needed in advance. All materials and instructions will be provided during the session.

## What to Expect

- The session will be conducted **in person** / **via video conference** will be adjusted as needed.
- You'll receive worksheets or digital templates to guide each stage. (Google sheets)
- The session will be **audio recorded** for research purposes (with your consent).
- All responses and feedback will be anonymized and kept confidential.

## Logistics

- **Date & Time**: [23.07.25 / 8:45 am]
- **Duration**: Approximately 3 hours
- **Materials**: Provided during session (framework overview, scenario, worksheets)

## Thank You

We deeply appreciate your time and insights. Your participation will help refine a practical framework that supports the integration of explainability in real-world AI systems through effective requirements engineering practices.